DATA COLLECTION REPORT

PlaySafe

Day 1 – Dataset selection

I started the project by searching for a suitable dataset for the injury prediction problem.

The dataset used in this project was obtained from the GitHub repository football-injury-scraper. The specific file used is laliga_players.csv.

laliga_players.csv – football-injury-scraper repository

I selected this dataset because it contains information about LaLiga players, their seasons, injuries, playing time and other player characteristics. These variables provide a suitable starting point for investigating whether player information and previous injury-related information can be used to predict injuries in a subsequent season.

After obtaining the dataset, I loaded it into the analysis environment and reviewed its structure before starting the data cleaning process.

Day 2 – Initial data inspection

I performed an initial inspection of the selected dataset.

The dataset contains 3,713 records and 15 variables. I checked the structure of the dataset, the data types, missing values and the format of the different variables.

Several data quality issues were identified. All variables were initially stored as strings, including numerical variables and dates. Some variables also contained values with additional text, such as "187 m" for height and "32 days" for the duration of an injury.

I identified missing values in several columns. In particular, the injury-related variables contain a large number of empty values. I also found 96 "-" values in matches_missed.

Two age variables, current_age_x and current_age_y, appear to represent the same concept but use different formats. current_age_x contains no empty values, while current_age_y contains missing values.

I also identified possible character encoding issues in some player names, such as "GalÃ¡n".

An important observation was that missing injury information should not automatically be interpreted as meaning that a player was never injured. This needs to be considered when defining the target variable for the prediction model.

Outcome

The initial inspection provided an overview of the dataset and identified the main data quality issues that need to be addressed. The next step is to clean and standardise the data, convert variables to appropriate data types and investigate the identified issues before continuing with exploratory analysis and feature analysis.